College of the Siskiyous
Nursing Program

Annual Update Program Review
Academic Year 2018-2019
December 2019

The college of the Siskiyous Nursing Program administers three separate programs that are overseen by three different state department boards. Therefore, each program was addressed separately with individual program reviews and outcomes. This overview addresses the state of the Nursing Program entity that administers and manages all three programs.

- **Describe Annual progress/changes/events in the program**

Changes in course offerings and course schedule have been described in the various individual program reports. Of note is that the change to a spring offering of the first course in the LVN-RN program, while requiring some adjustment, resulted in a positive outcome. The move of the course to spring allowed a better balance of faculty time, and less use of adjunct assistance, creating decrease in costs.

Additional funding provided under the CCCCO CNA Expansion Grant helped to increase overall enrollment in the CNA courses for the year. However, the course offered in the spring did not have sufficient enrollment to proceed. Although a total of 40 graduated successfully in the summer, the spring course offering does not appear viable in its present state. An historical review indicates that the timing of the spring course conflicts with other courses students need, and it does not allow for attendance by working students. In years in the past, the course was held in evenings and off hours, allowing students more flexibility; these options will be explored for the future offerings.

- **Describe progress on assessing SLOs and PLOs for the program**

The Nursing Program is celebrating very good outcomes for all three programs. All students who completed the course(s) in year 2018-2019 have passed their certification or licensure testing. This includes CNA certification testing, NCLEX-PN to date for the December graduates, and NCLEX-RN tests for the May graduates. Such outcomes of 100% in all three are an achievement.

Unofficial reports show that all graduates who have sought employment have been able to obtain a job in their area of study. Any problems encountered by those who passed in obtaining licensure were resolved.

- **Discuss any support or obstacles encountered by the program**

Program costs to the college District are primarily salaries and wages, including benefits. In addition to faculty, the program has three non-instructional (classified) support staff and the program director. Since student to faculty ratios must be low for clinical hospital experience and lab training, the Nursing Program tends to be a more costly program for the college. The community and region depend upon the nursing graduates to meet healthcare delivery needs. While there is active support within the community through offerings of clinical placements and specialty learning experiences, to date, no financial support has been offered. Efforts continue to find categorical funding to support needs and

new developments. For the 2018-2019 year, the program was able to maintain costs to the district at a minimal level ($11,000 to $13,000) for operational expenses outside of salaries and wages.

All three individual nursing programs seek to maintain enrollment at the maximum level of 30. Attrition is relatively small (3 to 10%) in the RN and CNA programs, however the rate of students dropping in the LVN program is considerably higher, and reached an alarming high of 36% in the 2018-2019 year. A curriculum revision is under way to make considerable changes to the program, and it is hoped that attrition will decrease once those changes are applied. Most students who drop do so during the first semester, and about 1/3 of those that drop state that they find that nursing is not the right path for them. Most importantly in the planned curriculum revision, a prerequisite of CNA will be required for entry into the LVN program. It is hoped that the preparation and experience of already having CNA training will help students to be successful and to know if nursing is the path that they want to follow.

Nursing tends to draw students with diverse backgrounds, and some have English as a second language. While foreign educated students may be well versed in sciences and mathematics, they may struggle in the finer levels of communication in the English language that are required in Nursing. With little ability to assess language levels and to provide tutorials through COS, College of the Siskiyous Nursing Program witnesses unsuccessful outcomes for many ESL students. During the 2018-2019 year, two ESL students dropped due to academic reasons in the LVN to RN program. Both had passed the rigorous admissions requirements, but both lacked enough command of English to have the immediate and detailed response required in the program.

The administration of a Nursing Program requires that the Director of Nursing be well versed in a number of areas and qualifications to be approved by the state nursing boards. The directorship is complex and demanding, involving compliance with the boards and numerous contracts with clinical facilities, multiple areas requiring supervision of faculty and staff, budget and grant management expertise, and much networking and liaison work. Because the college is small and very rural, clinical placements for students can require reaching out to distant areas and creating specialty experiences not usually integrated into many nursing programs. The state is currently facing a shortage of nursing program directors, with vacancies lasting for several years and managed by interim directors, returning retired directors and other arrangements in some colleges. The current COS director of nursing submitted an intention to retire letter in May 2019, giving the college over a year to work on the hiring process. The outcome remains to be seen for the 2019-2020 year and beyond.

- **Describe any program budgetary needs or implications**

The program managed to decrease dependency on the college District budget by finding grant support for several new expenditures. Improvements include the purchase of two Linet beds so that students can train on the beds currently being acquired by local and regional hospitals. The program purchased an electronic health record training program for students to learn to input their documentation correctly in preparation for their hospital experiences. Outdated laptops used in the labs and for testing were replaced. Faculty were able to attend important state meetings, conferences and trainings.

Outside of expected vacancies and refilling them, most costs can be covered by planned categorical expenditures. Categorical funding budgeted for the 2019-2020 year, will cover faculty training and instructional supplies needs, the replacement of a non-functioning ventilator for the simulation lab, updates to the scantron machine for test outcomes analysis, continuing equipment maintenance costs, and replacement of outdated lab items such as an additional bed.